

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

GLASSHOUSE

GRAND INDULGENCE

A Rs 451-crore lavish, hilltop beachfront office-cum-residence. No, it's not another billionaire residence, this one was okayed by ex-Andhra Pradesh CM **Y.S. Jagan Mohan Reddy** at Rushikonda, north of Visakhapatnam. His successor **N. Chandrababu Naidu** has now declared that the so-called 'Rushikonda Palace' would be thrown open for public scrutiny to "expose the extravagance". Jagan's alleged profligacy, details of which sworn enemy Naidu has gleefully laid bare, is as follows: a 200-tonne centralised air conditioning system, a Rs 4 lakh fan, a Rs 12 lakh toilet, a Rs 36 lakh bath tub... the list goes on. "Even the Rashtrapati Bhavan doesn't boast corridors this grand," Naidu remarked, touting the structure as proof that Jagan is indeed "the Andhra Escobar".



Security Snub

Biju Janata Dal (BJD) chief **Naveen Patnaik,** who was Odisha chief minister for 24 years, will now have just two constables to guard him. The BJP-led government, which ousted Patnaik earlier this year, has slashed his security from Z to Y category. The move follows an earlier cut in the security detail at his residence, which had still left 23 guards on duty. Now the remaining personnel, pilot convoy and Patnaik's official vehicle—he is still leader of the Opposition—will be withdrawn. Furious BJD leaders have slammed the BJP's action, calling it "unprecedented and disrespectful" to the venerated 79-year-old leader. The formal order on the downgrade is still to be issued though.

Kaushik Deka with Amarnath K. Menon, Arkamoy Datta Majumdar and Jeemon Jacob

APPEASING THE GODS

When Bengal's leading lady preps the *bhog* for the state deity, it has to be a spectacle. On October 31, CM **Mamata Banerjee** hosted the annual Kali Puja at her home, personally managing every detail and cooking a grand feast. Her social media team kept the updates coming, including moments with her grand-niece Ajaniya, daughter of MP Abhishek Banerjee, which predictably drew swoons of online affection. Abhishek made an appearance too, stylishly masked behind dark glasses after an eye surgery. Industrial heavyweights, film and TV bigwigs, TMC stalwarts, they were all there. One can only hazard a guess, but Mamata's prayers surely included pleas for some divine intervention to quell the protests her government's been facing of late.



ANI

Language Wars

CPI(M) Rajya Sabha member and veteran journalist **John Brittas** is aghast, taking strong exception to Union cabinet ministers sending official communication in Hindi, which he says contravenes the Official Languages Act, 1963. To register his protest, Brittas has written a reply in Malayalam to Ravneet Singh, the MoS for railways and food processing, which he later shared on social media. He pointed out that central government correspondence with southern MPs has traditionally been in English, but NDA ministers had been "deliberately imposing" Hindi on them of late. Count it as another strike for the north-south battles.



REDDY RESPONSE

Telangana CM **A. Revanth Reddy** has been relentless in countering critics of his administration. Responding to Prime Minister Narendra Modi's jab about the Congress government's "fake promises", Reddy declared that "Telangana is now rising" under his leadership, contrasting it with what he called a "decade of despair and gloom" under the previous Bharat Rashtra Samithi regime. Reddy also added that he was eager to "correct misconceptions and factual errors" made by the PM and put out a list of the initiatives and relevant statistics since the party assumed office last December.



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR